



Expense Reimbursement Policy

BluePeak Technologies | Business expense substantiation and repayment

Document ID	BPT-FIN-EXP-004	Version	v2.0
Effective date	2026-08-01	Next review	2027-01-01
Owner	Travel and Expense	Approved by	Executive Leadership Team
Classification	Internal	Category	Travel and Expenses
Audience	All employees	Status	Approved
Supersedes	BPT-FIN-EXP-004 v1.0	Source	https://employee.bluepeaktech.com/resources/finance/travel/expense-reimbursement

Document purpose. Business expense eligibility, receipts, reports, approvals, currency conversion, missing documentation, payment timing, taxable treatment, audits, and appeals.

Contents

Quick Answers 3

1. Purpose and Scope 3

2. Reimbursement Standards 3

3. Preferred Payment Method 3

4. Expense Categories 4

 4.1 Travel 4

 4.2 Business Meals and Customer Hospitality 4

 4.3 Office and Remote-Work Supplies 4

 4.4 Training, Memberships, and Conferences 4

 4.5 Gifts and Recognition 4

 4.6 Mobile and Internet Costs 4

 4.7 Relocation and Immigration 4

5. Receipts and Supporting Documentation 4

6. Missing Receipts 5

7. Currency Conversion 5

8. Submission Deadlines 5

9. Approval Workflow 5

 9.1 Employee Certification 5

 9.2 Manager or Budget Owner Review 5

 9.3 Finance Review 6

10. Reimbursement Timing 6

11. Non-Reimbursable Expenses 6

12. Exceptions, Audits, and Recovery 6

90. Administration, Exceptions, and Questions 6

91. Related Documents and Systems 7

Revision History 7

Quick Answers

Question	Current rule
What makes an expense reimbursable?	It must be ordinary and necessary for BluePeak business, reasonable, authorized, documented, and not otherwise paid by BluePeak.
When is a receipt required?	For any item over \$25 and for hotel, airfare or rail, rental vehicle, conference, gift, and other Finance-designated categories at any amount.
When are reports due?	Within 30 calendar days after domestic travel or the transaction; 60 calendar days after international travel.
When will I be reimbursed?	An approved report is scheduled for the next regular payroll, normally when final approval is received at least five business days before payroll cutoff.
Can I approve my own expense?	No. Every report requires an independent authorized approver.
What if a receipt is lost?	Request a duplicate first. If unavailable, complete the Missing Receipt Declaration; repeated declarations may be denied or audited.
Is my normal commute reimbursable?	No, except where mandatory law or a specific approved program provides otherwise.

Business purpose is essential: A receipt proves that money was spent; it does not prove that the cost was a valid BluePeak business expense. The report must explain who, what, where, when, and why.

1. Purpose and Scope

BluePeak reimburses employees for reasonable, necessary, properly authorized business expenses. This policy applies to out-of-pocket expenses and governs substantiation for corporate-card transactions. It is intended to operate as an accountable reimbursement arrangement where applicable, so timely business purpose and return of excess advances are required.

Travel purchasing standards are in the Travel Policy. Corporate card responsibilities are in the Corporate Credit Card Policy. Procurement contracts, purchase orders, payroll compensation, and vendor invoices are processed through their designated systems rather than an employee expense report.

2. Reimbursement Standards

An expense is reimbursable only when all of the following are true:

- 1 It has a clear and legitimate BluePeak business purpose.
- 2 The amount is reasonable for the location and circumstances.
- 3 Required approval was obtained before commitment when practical.
- 4 The employee used an approved supplier or method when required.
- 5 BluePeak, a customer, or another party has not already paid it.
- 6 The report is complete, accurate, timely, and supported.
- 7 The expense does not violate law, contract, the Code of Conduct, or another policy.

An approval confirms that the expense meets these criteria; it does not create authority to reimburse a personal, unlawful, duplicate, or unsupported charge.

3. Preferred Payment Method

Employees should use a BluePeak corporate card for eligible travel and purchasing when one has been issued. Out-of-pocket payment is appropriate when a card is not accepted, the employee does not have a card, the transaction is minor, or an emergency makes another method necessary.

Personal credit-card rewards do not justify using a personal card when a corporate card is required. BluePeak does not reimburse interest, late fees, annual fees, foreign-transaction fees avoidable through the corporate card, or losses caused by the employee's personal payment arrangement.

4. Expense Categories

4.1 Travel

Air, rail, lodging, ground transport, mileage, meals, and international costs must comply with the Travel Policy. The expense report should reference the approved trip request and identify any exception.

4.2 Business Meals and Customer Hospitality

A business meal must have a specific business purpose and reasonable attendees. Record the date, location, names and organizations of attendees, purpose, and itemized amount. The most senior BluePeak employee present should pay when practical. Meals involving a public official, healthcare professional, education customer, procurement decision-maker, or other regulated party require Legal guidance.

4.3 Office and Remote-Work Supplies

Reasonable role-related supplies may be reimbursed when not available through an approved purchasing channel. Furniture, monitors, phones, recurring software, and equipment require advance IT or Workplace approval and generally remain BluePeak property. The standard hybrid or remote internet allowance is administered through payroll and should not be duplicated on an expense report.

4.4 Training, Memberships, and Conferences

External training, certification, conference registration, and professional membership costs require advance manager and budget approval. The request should explain role relevance and cancellation terms. Academic tuition is reimbursed only under a separately approved education program.

4.5 Gifts and Recognition

Customer, partner, candidate, or employee gifts must comply with the Code of Conduct, procurement restrictions, tax rules, and any local limit. Cash and cash-equivalent gift cards are generally prohibited unless People Operations or Legal administers an approved recognition program. The expense record must identify the recipient and purpose.

4.6 Mobile and Internet Costs

A business call or short-term connectivity charge may be reimbursed when needed for travel or an emergency. Regular home internet is covered by the approved monthly allowance for eligible hybrid and remote employees. Personal mobile plans are not reimbursed unless a written role-based stipend applies.

4.7 Relocation and Immigration

Relocation, immigration, tax preparation, and home-office establishment expenses require a written agreement before the cost is incurred. Reimbursement may be taxable and may be subject to repayment terms. An ordinary expense approval cannot substitute for that agreement.

5. Receipts and Supporting Documentation

An itemized receipt is required for:

- 1 any individual expense over \$25;
- 1 lodging, airfare, rail, rental vehicles, conferences, and gifts at any amount;
- 1 any transaction the card issuer, auditor, tax authority, grant, or customer contract requires; and
- 1 any expense specifically requested by an approver or Finance.

A card slip showing only a total is not itemized. For lodging, attach the final folio showing nightly room, tax, fees, and personal charges. For airfare, attach the itinerary and payment confirmation. For mileage, record date, origin, destination, business purpose, and business miles.

Personal information that is not needed for the business record should be redacted. Do not upload full bank-account numbers, full payment-card numbers, medical records, or government identity documents.

6. Missing Receipts

The employee must first make a reasonable effort to obtain a duplicate from the merchant. When it is unavailable, complete the Missing Receipt Declaration with merchant, date, amount, payment method, business purpose, items purchased, reason the receipt is unavailable, and a certification that no duplicate reimbursement will be sought.

A declaration does not guarantee reimbursement. Finance may deny a high-risk, poorly described, or repeated unsupported expense. Three or more declarations in a rolling six-month period may trigger card retraining, additional approval, or suspension, absent a documented system issue.

7. Currency Conversion

Report an international expense in the original transaction currency and the reimbursement currency. Use the corporate-card posted amount when available. For a personal payment, use the actual card-statement conversion or the expense platform's rate for the transaction date. Currency-exchange commissions and unavoidable foreign transaction fees may be included.

A cash withdrawal requires advance Finance approval and is reconciled as a travel advance. The employee must return unused cash or excess advance promptly and no later than 10 business days after trip end.

8. Submission Deadlines

Submit expenses within:

- 1 30 calendar days after a domestic transaction or domestic trip end; and
- 1 60 calendar days after an international trip end.

A report older than 60 days requires department-head and Finance approval and may be treated as taxable income. A report older than 120 days is ordinarily denied unless a documented emergency, leave, system outage, or legal requirement justifies the delay.

Corporate-card transactions must also meet the card reconciliation deadline even when the travel report deadline is longer.

9. Approval Workflow

9.1 Employee Certification

By submitting a report, the employee certifies that it is accurate, complete, business-related, not previously reimbursed, and compliant. Knowingly false certification may result in corrective action and repayment.

9.2 Manager or Budget Owner Review

The approver verifies business purpose, reasonableness, budget, attendees, policy compliance, and required preapproval. The approver must return an incomplete report rather than inserting an unsupported explanation. A person may not approve their own expense; a higher-level approver reviews an executive's or primary approver's report.

9.3 Finance Review

Finance performs risk-based review, including duplicate detection, receipt validation, category coding, tax treatment, customer-billable support, policy exceptions, split transactions, and unusual patterns. Finance may request information from the employee, manager, Legal, Security, or Procurement.

10. Reimbursement Timing

A fully approved report is scheduled for the next regular payroll, normally when final approval reaches Expense Operations at least five business days before payroll cutoff. A later approval moves to the following payroll. A confirmed urgent hardship may be paid off-cycle with Payroll and Finance approval.

Reimbursement appears separately from wages. Taxable reimbursements are identified and withheld through payroll. BluePeak is not responsible for personal-card payment deadlines; employees should submit promptly and pay personal accounts according to their terms.

11. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

Examples include ordinary commuting, personal entertainment, childcare or pet care, clothing not required as a uniform or protective equipment, traffic and parking fines, political contributions, charitable donations not approved by Corporate Responsibility, personal insurance, home utilities beyond an approved allowance, cash equivalents, unlawful goods or services, luxury upgrades, companion costs, personal subscriptions, and expenses caused by misconduct.

A list cannot anticipate every situation. The controlling question is whether the cost is reasonable, necessary, authorized BluePeak business.

12. Exceptions, Audits, and Recovery

A policy exception requires a documented business reason and approval from the budget owner's vice president and Finance. An emergency exception may be approved after the fact when advance approval was impractical. An exception should be attached to the report.

BluePeak may audit any expense or corporate-card transaction. The employee must cooperate and retain original supporting information until the report is approved. Duplicate, personal, unsupported, or otherwise improper reimbursements must be repaid. BluePeak will use a lawful recovery process and may take corrective action for intentional misuse.

An employee may ask Expense Operations to reconsider a denial and may escalate a continuing disagreement to the Controller. Retaliation for a good-faith question or report is prohibited.

90. Administration, Exceptions, and Questions

BluePeak administers business expense reimbursement consistently with the employee's work location, employment classification, written employment terms, and applicable law. A statutory or contractual entitlement that is more generous than this document will apply to the extent required. A manager may not waive a legal requirement, create a new benefit, or promise an exception without written approval from the document owner.

Employees should raise questions before relying on an informal interpretation. Contact expenses@bluepeaktech.com through Outlook or the People Help channel in Microsoft Teams. Payroll, Legal, Information Security, or a site leader will be consulted when the question involves tax, wage-and-hour, privacy, immigration, safety, or local-law considerations.

Approved exceptions must identify the employee, the policy provision, the business reason, the approving authority, the start and end date, and any conditions. Exceptions are stored with the employee or transaction record and do not establish a precedent for other employees.

91. Related Documents and Systems

Resource	When to use it
Expense Reimbursement Form	Submitting itemized out-of-pocket expenses and approval certifications.
Travel Policy	Approval, booking, lodging, meals, mileage, and international travel standards.
Corporate Credit Card Policy	Card use, statement reconciliation, custody, and prohibited charges.
Company Code of Conduct	Gifts, conflicts, anti-bribery, accurate records, and non-retaliation.
Payroll Schedule & Direct Deposit Policy	Reimbursement delivery and payroll cutoffs.

Revision History

Version	Effective date	Change summary
v2.0	2026-08-01	Separated travel standards from expense processing and added accountable-plan, approval, audit, and reimbursement controls.